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## New high for Dubai's public transit system

DUBAI  
BY ASHFAQ AHMED  
Senior Assistant Editor

Dubai's integrated public transport systems including the Dubai Metro, Dubai Tram, public buses, marine transport, taxis, and app-based mobility services, served approximately 395.3 million riders in the first half of 2025.

According to the Roads and Transport Authority (RTA), Dubai's public transport network is now moving more than 2.18 million people daily. It represents a 9 per cent increase compared to around 361.2 million riders during the same period in 2024. Average daily ridership rose from 1.98 million a year earlier.

### Dubai Metro tops

According to the RTA, Dubai Metro and taxis recorded the highest ridership shares, at 36.5 per cent and 26 per cent, respectively. Public buses followed with a 24 per cent share. A total of 143.9 million riders used the Red and Green Lines of Dubai Metro in H1 2025.

Mattar Al Tayer, Director General and Chairman of the Board of Executive Directors of the RTA, said, "Dubai's public transport network has undergone a major transformation, driven by advanced infrastructure and a diverse range of transit options. As a result, the share of journeys using public transport and shared mobility has increased from 6 per cent in 2006 to 21.6 per cent in 2024."

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# UAE conducts aid airdrop amid 'unprecedented crisis' in Gaza

UAE AID TRUCKS HAVE BEGUN ENTERING THE BESIEGED STRIP FROM EGYPT

ABU DHABI  
BY KHITAM ALAMIR  
Chief News Editor

UAE planes dropped food into Gaza yesterday after Shaikh Abdullah Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Foreign Affairs, affirmed that the humanitarian situation in the Gaza Strip had reached a critical and unprecedented stage.

The Jordanian military said its planes, working with the UAE, had delivered 25 tonnes of aid in three parachute drops over Gaza yesterday, the 54th airdrop conducted by the UAE.

Since the launch of the Birds of Goodness initiative, a total of approximately 3,725 tonnes of food and relief supplies have been airdropped into Gaza using 193 aircraft. These supplies included essential food items and vital relief materials to meet the urgent needs of families affected by the dire and catastrophic humanitarian conditions in the Strip.

### UAE leads efforts

Shaikh Abdullah emphasised that the UAE remains at the forefront of efforts to deliver life-saving assistance to the Palestinian people.

In a post yesterday on his account on the social media platform X, Shaikh Abdullah said: "We will continue delivering relief support to those most in need — by land, air, and sea," reaffirming the immediate resumption of airdrop operations for humanitarian aid.

Shaikh Abdullah stressed that the UAE's commitment to



■ An UAE aid truck on the Egyptian side of the Rafah crossing with the Gaza Strip driving toward the besieged Palestinian territory yesterday.  
AFP

alleviating suffering and supporting the Palestinian people is resolute and unwavering.

Meanwhile, aid trucks began entering the Gaza Strip from Egypt yesterday, AFP TV footage showed, as Israel announced a "tactical pause" in parts of the devastated territory to allow deliveries.

Egyptian state-linked media had earlier confirmed the movement of convoys, sharing footage of trucks at the border area.

Trucks crossing the Rafah border however cannot enter Gaza directly as the Palestinian side of the crossing was seized by the Israel military last year and has been badly damaged.

Instead, they must detour a



Watch: Aid trucks begin entering Gaza through the Rafah crossing

few kilometres to the nearby Kerem Shalom (Karam Abu Salem) crossing, which is controlled by Israel. There, they are inspected before being allowed into southern Gaza.

### Aid trucks enter

AFP footage showed large trucks loaded with white sacks moving through the Egyptian side of the Rafah gate.

Some trucks displayed the Emirati flag, with signs reading:

"United Arab Emirates — Humanitarian Aid to Gaza — Water Support Projects in Gaza", while others had the logo of the Egyptian Red Crescent.

The Israeli military said the daily pause in the enclave, running from 10am to 8pm, would apply only to specific areas, including Al Mawasi, Deir Al Balah, and parts of Gaza City, where Israeli troops are not currently operating. It added that secure routes had been opened across the enclave to facilitate United Nations and other aid convoys. The move comes amid mounting international pressure over Gaza's worsening hunger crisis.

— with inputs from agencies  
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## UAE NRIs to face limits on UPI use

UPI limits to cut system strain — balance checks, status views capped

DUBAI  
BY JUSTIN VARGHESE  
Your Money Editor

The National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) is implementing new usage rules for UPI from August 1, aimed at reducing system congestion during peak hours.

While UPI remains free and fully functional, frequent users — including UAE NRIs with Indian bank accounts — will now face daily limits on how often they can check bal-

### UPI CHANGES

- Balance checks limited to 50 per day
- Bank account views capped at 25 per day
- Transaction status: 3 refreshes only
- AutoPay transactions to follow fixed time slots

ances and transaction status. For starters, balance checks will be limited to 50 per day, which means if you check your UPI-linked account balance multiple times a day, you'll now be restricted to 50 balance checks daily.

Besides that, bank account

views will be capped at 25 per day, meaning users can only view their linked account details up to 25 times a day in a move to cut background traffic that slows the system.

### Designated time windows

Also, only 3 refreshes will be allowed to know transaction status which means after making a payment, you can only check its status 3 times, with a 90-second interval between each.

Finally, AutoPay transactions will follow fixed time slots. This means recurring UPI transactions like subscriptions or EMIs will now process in designated time windows, improving stability and speed.

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